

AUGMENTED REALITY: How Real Is The Interaction



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Not many people were aware of the concept of augmented reality until Pokémon Go came in to the picture. This game has been taking the world by storm. Augmented reality uses techniques to expand the real world outside your imagination. Many Android and iOS apps are now being designed using the principle of augmented reality.

Augmented Reality is an absolute or composite view of the physical or real environment superimposed with virtual elements that have been enhanced by computer-generated sensory input like sound, video, graphics and GPS. You can digitally manipulate the information about your surroundings in real time using the phenomenal augmented reality technology.

Key characteristics of augmented reality are:

1. Overlapping of real and digital worlds

2. Registration and alignment in 3D
3. Real-time interaction

Augmented reality is already being used in many areas, some of which are:

Virtual dressing rooms. This is an augmented reality based dressing room application, where you can select your favourite clothes and accessories virtually without buying or even trying these on physically.

In military camps. In combat, augmented reality can serve as a networked technology for the communication system that assimilates useful battlefield data onto a soldier's goggles in real time. From the soldier's view, people and various objects can be marked with special indicators to warn of potential dangers. The map evokes the layers of the indicated trajectories for various objects in geographic coordinates. It supports telescope operators in identifying satellites and cataloguing potentially-dangerous Space debris.

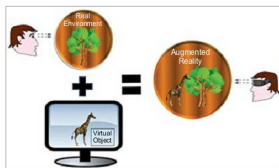


Fig. 1: Concept of augmented reality

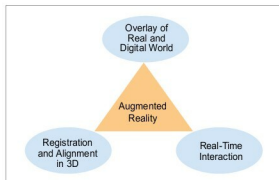


Fig. 2: Characteristics of augmented reality

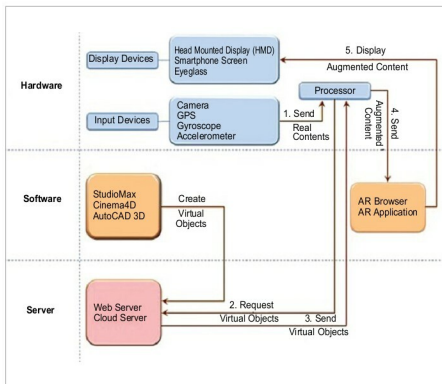


Fig. 3: Components of augmented reality